

Kai Luzniak

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EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz

Expected June 2028

B.S. Computer Science | GPA: 3.9 (Dean's Honors)

- Activities: Tech4Good Research Assistant (Web Development); Slug Gaming Developer; UCSC Computer Lounges Systems Administrator; Gen.G Collegiate Ambassador; Former Top 100 Overwatch Player; VSA Intern.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, C, C++, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6), C#, Lua, HTML/CSS

Frameworks/Technologies: React, React Router, Node.js, Express, PostgreSQL, Docker, Tailwind CSS, Unity, Mirror, MQTT, AWS EC2

Tools: Git, GitHub, Jira, Linux/Unix, Bash, Figma, Cursor, GitHub Copilot, Codex

EXPERIENCE

Slug Gaming (University of California, Santa Cruz)

Santa Cruz, CA

Software Developer & Executive Board Member

June 2025 – Present

- Built and maintained the Slug Gaming website using **React**, **React Router**, **JavaScript** (ES6), and **Tailwind CSS**, supporting a **3,700+** member community.
- Led UI/UX decisions through a self-authored design document, aligning layout, branding, and user flows to improve clarity and accessibility (**Lighthouse Accessibility +20%**).
- Coordinated with **11 directors** and **120+ players** to maintain rosters, bios, and graphics; shipped updates via Git.

Northrop Grumman

El Segundo, CA

Embedded Software Engineer Mentee

Sep 2023 – Jun 2025

- Selected as **one of 5 students** for Northrop Grumman's High School Involvement Program; built a scale-model smart-home system with **4 Raspberry Pis**, GPIO-connected sensors and actuators, and a dedicated router.
- Prototyped sensor and actuator circuits in **TinkerCAD** and **Arduino IDE (C++)**, then implemented Raspberry Pi control logic in Python for the live smart-home demo.
- Developed the Cheshire Cat voice assistant using **Python**, **Linux**, **MQTT/Mosquitto**, and the **OpenRouter API** to process voice commands and trigger hardware automation; served as Scrum Master for a **10-week Agile sprint**.

Boeing Defense, Space & Security

El Segundo, CA

Technical Program Management Intern

Jun 2024 – Aug 2024

- Developed a project management tool in **HCL Leap** to surface Agile workflow training gaps, adopted by **100+** employees and used by managers to guide targeted training efforts.
- Automated project reporting using **Excel VBA** by cleaning and parsing inconsistent raw data formats for a **\$1.3M** R&D initiative, improving reporting efficiency and data usability.
- Identified software access bottlenecks through employee and intern interviews; proposed a cloud deployment solution reducing download downtime by **70%**, earning finalist recognition in Boeing's LINC innovation challenge.

Code Ninjas

El Segundo, CA

Coding Instructor

Oct 2024 – Jun 2025

- **Mentored 100+ K-12 students** in **C#**, **Unity**, and **Microsoft MakeCode**; led workshops on AI and design.

PROJECTS

Cata (2D Roguelike) | Project Lead, Unity (C#), Mirror, Git, Jira, Cursor

Jan 2025 – Jun 2025

- Founded and led a 6-person team; introduced team to Jira for sprint planning and Cursor for AI-assisted development.
- Implemented online multiplayer architecture in Unity (C#) using Mirror, including custom network management, lobby flow, room joining, player spawning, and client-server synchronization.
- Built core gameplay systems for movement, combat, rounds, power-up cards, health, and projectiles; hosted playtests on **AWS EC2** and earned **1st Place – Game of the Year (2025)** among all Da Vinci CS Pathway game studios.

Haiku Diem | React Native, Expo, TypeScript, Supabase, PostgreSQL

July 2026 – Present

- Built a cross-platform mobile app with **React Native**, **Expo**, and **TypeScript**, featuring file-based routing, reusable UI components, daily haiku creation, and a custom touch-driven **32x32 pixel-art editor**.
- Implemented a **Supabase/PostgreSQL** backend with authentication, Row Level Security, relational entry/profile models, and JSONB-based pixel storage to persist user-generated haikus and artwork securely.